6.1.3 Other open source frontends

In addition to Grafana and Kibana/OpenSearch Dashboards, there are two more open source frontends you may want to have a look at when you evaluate options:

- Apache Superset (https://superset.apache.org/), available under the Apache License Version 2.0, positions itself as a data exploration and visualization platform that supports a wide array of databases (http://mng.bz/1qWj), including Amazon Athena, Google BigQuery, ClickHouse, Elasticsearch, MySQL, and TimescaleDB; however, Prometheus support is, at time of writing, not available. It became a top-level Apache Software Foundation (ASF) project in early 2021 and has a number of contributors, including Airbnb (where it started), Dropbox and Lyft.
- Metabase (https://github.com/metabase/metabase) promises to enable "everyone in your company to ask questions and learn from data," which is very suitable for observability use cases. It is released under the AGPL as well as commercial licenses and has a strong SQL focus. You can connect (http://mng.bz/Pzpn) Metabase to a range of databases (including Google BigQuery, PostgreSQL, and Snowflake), and more options are available via partner and community drivers. In addition to the open source DIY model, you can use the commercial managed offering (https://www.metabase.com/pricing/) under the same name, either on-premises or in the cloud. Now, let's move on to the cloud provider and ISV offerings.

6.1.4 Cloud providers and commercial frontends

In this space, you will often hear or read the term *business intelligence* (BI)—think observability for business processes. Indeed, many of the offerings in this space stem from there and have been adapted to or are used in the observability context as a specific use case area. Let's have a closer look:

- *Amazon QuickSight (https://aws.amazon.com/quicksight/)*—A cloud BI service by AWS that you can use for dashboarding and reporting. It also supports many popular backends, including Amazon Athena, S3, OpenSearch, and Salesforce.
- *Looker Studio (https://lookerstudio.google.com/overview)*—Google's BI offering as a service, supporting a range of visualizations and connectors to hundreds of backends.
- *Microsoft Power BI (https://powerbi.microsoft.com/en-us/)*—The BI cloud offering of Microsoft that supports data marts and apps with deep integration into the Microsoft office suite. Alternatively, you can use Azure dashboards (https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/azure/azure-portal/azure-portal-dashboards), which comes with several out-of-the-box integrations with Azure Monitoring.
- *Tableau (https://www.tableau.com/)*—A visual analytics platform you can use in many different setups, from desktop to on-prem to the cloud, supporting a large number of data sources and visualizations.